

## The Grassroots Project

Nonprofit in DC, partner w/ D1 athletes at schools in DC, train athletes to give comprehensive health education courses to unprivileged middle schoolers in DC area  
-Athletes form connection with students, build a level of trust with them, connection of sports = powerful

- What challenges was the client facing? Where did they need our help?

-During COVID - challenge for all nonprofits

funding just from grants (gov), uncertainty with how pandemic would impact funding

Wanted more corporate sponsors

looked for potential corp sponsors that were aligned with their mission, companies

focused on youth, health, etc

compiled big list

Had a spring gala - big deal, fundraiser, wasn't sure if it would be feasible

research in having online → scrapped it, focused on other fundraising efforts

Spring sem - focus → considering expansion beyond dc - potentially philadelphia

research on health stats in Philly - school & sexual & mental & nutritional health

Philly stats - health & equity ← big focus of work

Got more feedback from Tyler

Created a pitch deck - for expansion

Team created layout, needed to tailor it to different audiences, had quotes, etc target audience - athletes to recruit, donors

alternate endings for diff target audiences

Lots of feedback - built a narrative with stats, told a story

Final deliverable in spring - gave them the pitch as if we were them, to them → was helpful how we verbalized the mission, helped them think about how they pitched to other people

wanted deck to be slides heavy - so they could send it in an email

needed to be visually appealing but have info as well

- How did DCivitas strategize to solve the problem?

looked at funding profile, potential corp, tried to match corps with project

- What solution did we provide to the client?
- What was the impact of our solution?

-difficult to quantify

-still working on philly expansion, contributed to beginning

had not started talking to donors or schools at all yet

provided preliminary work

impact unsure - due to COVID

#### Intro:

Combination of everything below

#### Client summary:

Grassroots Project - DC nonprofit that partners w/ D1 athletes at DC schools  
Trains athletes - give health ed courses to unprivileged middle schoolers  
Athletes form connections, build trust  
Connection of sports = powerful

#### Challenges:

COVID challenges - mainly funding  
Funding was just from government grants, needed more sponsors  
Wanted expansion beyond DC - potentially Philadelphia

#### Solution:

Compiled lists of potential corporate sponsors that were aligned with their mission:  
focuses on youth, health, etc  
Research on health stats in Philly → esp health & equity  
Created a pitch deck for the expansion

#### Results??

Unsure - Philly expansion still ongoing  
Grassroots had been in beginning stages, hadn't talked to any donors or schools  
DCivitas did provide preliminary work  
Impact unsure, mostly due to COVID

The Grassroot Project (TGP) was founded in 2009 by a small group of Georgetown student athletes who sought to educate several DC schools on HIV prevention. With a low national percentage of students meeting health education and physical activity standards standards, TGP has since then has expanded into a full-fledged team of over 1,000 NCAA varsity athletes who are trained to provide comprehensive health education courses and mentorship through sports and games to underprivileged DC teens. DCivitas worked with TGP to find funding during the pandemic and spearheaded research to create an extensive deliverable which assisted their beginning expansion beyond DC.

### Challenges

DCivitas worked with TGP during the COVID-19 pandemic where uncertainty created difficulties in securing funding. Though TGP received government grants, they wanted more corporate sponsors. In addition, TGP was in the early stages of expanding, potentially to Philadelphia, a large step for a DC-based organization. They needed to consolidate their goals and plans there, which required additional research.

### Strategy

DCivitas looked for potential corporate sponsors that aligned with TGP's mission of promoting health among youth populations. We compiled a list of such companies so they could have many options. We also conducted research on health statistics in Philadelphia about schools and the administration of sexual, mental, and nutritional health to see what TGP's framework there should achieve. A large proponent of our research focused on the intersection between health and equity in the city and how that affects the youth.

### Deliverable

Using our research, we provided TGP with the information and presentation framework needed to begin their Philadelphia expansion. DCivitas synthesized data regarding the unique demographics and culture of Philadelphia, then strategically developed messaging and visuals to pitch the Grassroot Project mission for the city.